

Course Title: Foundational Music Theory

Age Group: age 7+

Duration: Full Year (Music Theory 1 first semester, Music Theory second semester)

Room: TBD

Course Description

This course introduces students to the foundational elements of music theory, including notation, rhythm, scales and key signatures, intervals and chords. Students will develop the skills necessary to read, write, and understand music and apply theoretical knowledge to composition. The class is ideal for students with a general music interest, and those who play instruments or sing. Students in this class will take the knowledge from this course and apply it in real life as they help work with Chorus, Band, and Orchestra for elementary or secondary schools. This will teach them new skills, helping them be more fluent in music reading, and preparing them for general music classes.

Course Objectives

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Read and write music in treble and bass clefs.
- Understand and construct major and minor scales.
- Identify intervals and chord structures.
- Understanding and identifying basic musical forms and harmonic progressions.
- Compose short melodies.

- Develop basic ear training and sight singing skills.

Units of Study

Fall:

Week 1-2: Staff, clefs, and note naming

Week 3-5: Rhythmic notation and meter

Week 6-8: Major scales and key signatures

Week 9-11: Solfege and sight singing

Week 12-14: Minor scales and key signatures

Spring:

Week 1-4: Intervals

Week 5-8: Triads

Week 9-12: Roman numeral analysis

Week 13-16: Simple melody composition

Students Materials Needed

- Staff paper (unless school can print)
- Notebook
- Pencil and eraser
- Folder or binder for handouts

Grading Policy

- Classwork/Homework 60%
- Quizzes & Composition 40%

Assessments

- Theory quizzes
- Ear training and sight-singing checks
- Final project: composition

Teacher Textbook:

Concise Introduction to Tonal Harmony Second Edition by L. Poundie Burstein and Joseph N. Straus